



WEEKLY EPIDEMIOLOGICAL REPORT

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20th – 26th July 2026

Journey to malaria elimination and challenges in sustaining Prevention of Re-establishment (PoR) phase of malaria in Sri Lanka - II

This is the second article of three in a series on "Journey to malaria elimination and challenges in sustaining Prevention of Re-establishment (PoR) phase of malaria in Sri Lanka"

Prevention of Re-establishment (PoR) of Malaria

The primary objective of the prevention of re-establishment (PoR) phase is to prevent the re-introduction and re-establishment of indigenous malaria transmission while safeguarding the achievements of sustained malaria control and elimination efforts. This strategy is underpinned by early detection and effective management of imported cases, quality-assured diagnosis and treatment, continuous entomological surveillance, and rapid outbreak response (6).

Sri Lanka's PoR programme has demonstrated both its resilience and its capacity for continuous improvement. Investigations of introduced and transfusion-transmitted malaria cases identified critical gaps in surveillance and follow-up, which were subsequently addressed through strengthened response measures, highlighting the importance of maintaining vigilant and proactive surveillance systems(8).

Figure 01: Imported malaria cases reported in Sri Lanka, from 2013–2026

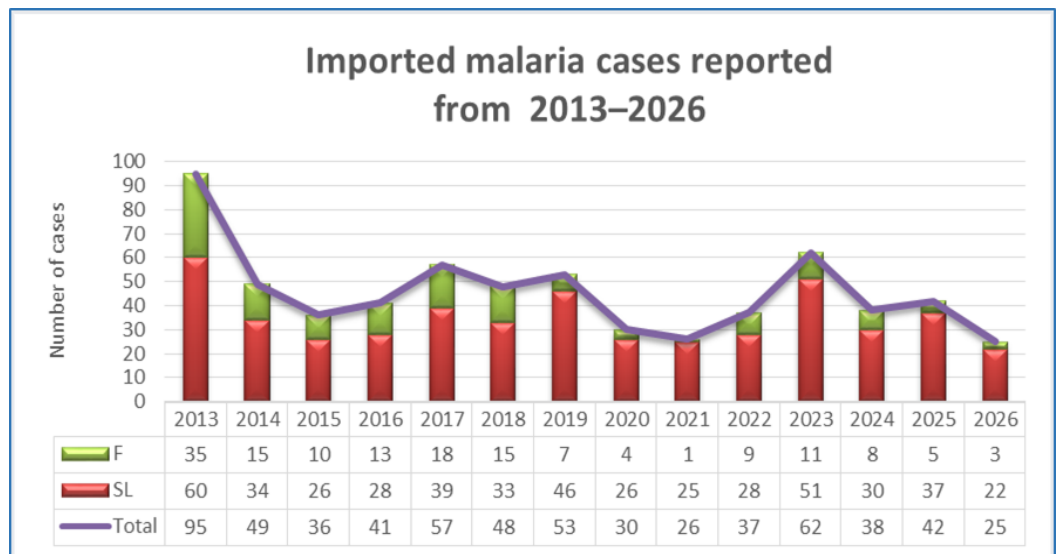


Figure 01: Imported malaria cases reported in Sri Lanka, from 2013–2026

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SRI LANKA 2026

WEEKLY

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Table 1 : Water Quality Surveillance
Number of microbiological water samples June 2026

District	MOH areas	No: Expected *	No: Received
Colombo	18	108	00
Gampaha	15	90	20
Kalutara	13	78	83
Kalutara NIHS	2	12	6
Kandy	23	138	78
Matale	13	78	57
Nuwara Eliya	13	78	48
Galle	20	120	NR
Matara	17	102	08
Hambantota	12	72	114
Jaffna	14	84	142
Kilinochchi	4	24	18
Mannar	5	30	14
Vavuniya	4	24	41
Mullatvu	6	36	43
Batticaloa	14	84	0
Ampara	7	42	NR
Trincomalee	12	72	NR
Kurunegala	29	174	51
Puttlam	13	78	0
Anuradhapura	23	138	NR
Polonnaruwa	9	54	22
Badulla	16	96	127
Moneragala	11	66	NR
Rathnapura	20	120	125
Kegalle	11	66	57
Kalmunai	13	78	0

* No of samples expected (6 / MOH area / Month)
 NR = Return not received

Table 1: Distribution of Notified Diseases reported by Medical Officers of Health 13th – 19th July 2026 (29th Week)

RDHS	Dengue Fever		Dysentery		Encephalitis		En. Fever		F. Poison-		Leptospirosis		Typhus		Viral Hep.		H. Rabies		Chickenpox		Meningitis		Leishman.		Tuberculosis		Leprosy		WRCD	
	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	T*	C**
Colombo	1330	14714	0	16	0	2	0	4	0	19	3	199	0	2	1	12	0	0	6	344	3	67	0	3	32	1044	1	98	98	100
Gampaha	1501	12266	1	30	2	30	0	0	0	23	6	327	0	5	0	9	0	0	6	546	0	184	0	36	24	580	0	47	78	100
Kalutara	592	5970	1	34	0	3	0	8	0	62	13	274	0	6	0	17	0	0	9	536	3	92	0	12	11	337	5	54	81	100
Kandy	681	4864	0	39	0	8	0	7	0	38	2	135	0	26	2	18	0	0	12	434	4	95	0	41	10	302	1	19	64	100
Matale	85	1993	0	19	0	5	0	2	0	7	0	142	0	3	1	8	0	0	5	138	1	55	8	316	2	101	1	24	91	100
Nuwara Eliya	112	835	0	34	1	5	0	3	0	15	6	205	3	32	0	13	0	0	3	326	3	145	0	1	0	147	0	8	84	100
Galle	379	5065	2	23	0	11	0	8	1	55	13	372	1	29	0	17	0	0	13	660	2	110	0	2	11	246	6	38	86	93
Hambantota	215	2269	4	37	0	2	0	0	5	39	10	165	0	22	0	11	0	0	0	155	1	45	7	311	0	83	1	21	100	100
Matara	552	5392	0	18	0	3	0	2	0	11	14	255	1	17	0	15	0	0	6	374	3	131	3	92	2	89	1	14	93	100
Jaffna	54	884	9	57	0	6	0	19	2	90	0	52	2	229	0	1	0	0	3	263	4	37	0	1	0	103	0	11	96	100
Kilinochchi	4	627	2	12	0	1	0	8	0	1	0	76	1	12	0	3	0	1	0	91	0	12	0	2	0	20	0	2	100	100
Mannar	13	523	0	1	0	3	0	0	0	3	0	45	0	4	0	3	0	0	0	63	0	20	1	5	2	29	0	3	94	100
Vavuniya	12	296	1	19	0	4	0	2	0	8	2	98	0	4	0	1	0	0	2	114	0	30	0	21	1	42	0	6	100	99
Mullaitivu	5	78	0	6	0	2	1	1	0	8	0	34	0	4	0	2	0	0	0	11	0	9	0	9	0	17	1	7	100	100
Batticaloa	44	1344	1	54	1	10	0	2	0	16	5	137	0	2	0	16	0	0	9	212	1	69	0	21	3	90	5	69	98	100
Ampara	77	511	1	48	0	1	0	1	1	16	1	112	0	2	1	8	0	0	4	234	2	56	1	13	1	30	1	17	97	100
Trincomalee	25	668	1	18	0	6	0	2	0	14	2	74	0	8	0	2	0	0	8	150	0	27	0	18	1	93	0	6	100	100
Kurunegala	266	2708	0	18	0	16	0	3	1	65	6	286	1	25	0	10	0	1	13	535	8	273	12	271	7	187	2	46	92	100
Puttalam	163	1341	0	16	0	11	0	0	0	7	5	185	0	21	0	7	0	4	1	107	5	117	0	15	5	107	0	18	75	100
Anuradhapura	118	806	1	18	0	8	0	1	0	49	2	182	1	22	0	8	0	0	17	381	3	116	27	469	0	153	0	35	88	100
Polonnaruwa	64	666	0	21	0	7	0	2	0	59	5	217	0	7	1	24	0	0	8	321	3	51	28	345	0	50	0	57	100	100
Badulla	164	1246	0	32	0	8	0	3	1	13	3	180	3	33	3	109	0	0	8	292	4	197	0	84	2	152	0	15	93	100
Monaragala	106	1030	0	14	0	3	0	1	3	8	3	202	0	28	1	41	0	1	2	162	2	75	8	143	2	72	0	13	96	100
Ratnapura	315	4440	0	25	0	6	0	6	1	17	10	623	2	29	0	11	0	0	1	263	6	70	2	132	8	241	0	24	97	100
Kegalle	247	2133	1	41	0	4	0	4	0	24	16	266	0	10	2	12	0	0	8	454	1	67	1	13	5	186	0	7	63	100
Kalmunai	46	849	1	36	0	1	0	1	0	19	1	56	0	1	0	3	0	0	5	352	1	26	0	0	0	73	0	23	100	100
SRILANKA	7170	73518	26	686	4	166	1	90	15	686	128	4899	15	583	12	381	0	7	149	7518	60	2176	98	2376	129	4574	25	682	91	100

Source: WRCD module of the EPINET.
A = Cases reported during the current week;
T*=Timeliness refers to returns received on or before 19th July, 2026.
B = Cumulative cases for the year.
Total number of reporting units 360
C**=Completeness;
C**=Completeness;

Table 2: Selected Vaccine Preventable Diseases & AFP

13th – 19th July 2026 (29th Week)

Disease	No. of Cases by Province									Number of cases during current week in 2026	Number of cases during same week in 2025	Total number of cases to date in 2026	Total number of cases to date in 2025	Difference between the number of cases to date in 2026 & 2025
	W	C	S	N	E	NW	NC	U	Sab					
AFP ¹	01	00	00	00	01	00	00	00	00	02	02	41	36	13.8%
Diphtheria	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	0 %
Mumps ²	01	01	00	00	00	00	01	00	01	04	04	84	92	-8.6 %
Measles ³	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	02	02	00	34	02	1600 %
Rubella ³	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	0 %
CRS ²	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	0 %
Tetanus ²	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	04	03	33.3 %
Neonatal Tetanus ²	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	0 %
Japanese Encephalitis ³	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	04	-100 %
Whooping Cough ²	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	00	19	12	58.3 %

Key to Table 2

Provinces: W: Western, C: Central, S: Southern, N: North, E: East, NC: North Central, NW: North Western, U: Uva, Sab: Sabaragamuwa.

Data Sources:

Weekly Return of Communicable Diseases: Diphtheria, Mumps, Tetanus, Neonatal Tetanus, Whooping Cough.

Special Surveillance: AFP, Measles, Rubella, CRS.

AFP¹ = No Polio cases

Mumps², CRS², Tetanus², Neonatal Tetanus², Whooping Cough²—Clinically and/ or laboratory confirmed cases

Measles³, Rubella³, Japanese Encephalitis³— Laboratory Confirmed cases

AFP—Acute Flaccid Paralysis

CRS = Congenital Rubella Syndrome

NA = Not Available

AFP and all Vaccine Preventable Diseases should be investigated by the MOH Personally.

All patients presenting with fever and a maculopapular rash must be promptly notified and investigated. Blood samples and throat swabs should be collected at the appropriate time window

Comments and contributions for publication in the WER Sri Lanka are welcome. However, the editor reserves the right to accept or reject items for publication. All correspondence should be mailed to The Editor, WER Sri Lanka, Epidemiology Unit, P.O. Box 1567, Colombo or sent by E-mail to chepid@sltnet.lk. The Epidemiology Unit should be formally acknowledged in all resulting publications as the primary data source.

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